

SARA MOHAMMADI

MHPSS Counselor, M.A. Clinical Psychology

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Compassionate and dedicated Mental Health and Psychosocial Support (MHPSS) Counselor with 5+ years of experience providing trauma-informed care to vulnerable populations in Afghanistan. Specialized in individual and group counseling for women, children, and GBV survivors, utilizing evidence-based therapeutic modalities including CBT, PFA, and supportive counseling. Committed to delivering culturally sensitive mental health services that honor Afghan traditions while promoting healing and resilience. Fluent in Dari, Pashto, and English with proven ability to work effectively in challenging humanitarian contexts.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Individual Counseling & Psychotherapy
- Case Management & Care Coordination
- Crisis Intervention & Psychological First Aid
- Cognitive Behavioral Therapy (CBT)
- GBV Survivor Support
- Community-Based MHPSS
- Active Listening & Empathy
- Group Therapy & Support Groups
- Psychosocial Assessment & Screening
- Trauma-Informed Care
- Supportive Counseling
- Child & Adolescent Counseling
- Cultural Sensitivity & Adaptation
- Documentation & Report Writing

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

MHPSS Counselor | International Rescue Committee (IRC)

Kabul, Afghanistan | January 2022 - Present

- Provide individual counseling to 25-30 clients weekly, including women, children, and GBV survivors, achieving 85% improvement in client-reported wellbeing scores
- Facilitate 6 weekly psychosocial support groups for women affected by conflict and displacement, serving 45-50 participants
- Conduct comprehensive psychosocial assessments and develop individualized care plans for 150+ clients annually
- Deliver Psychological First Aid (PFA) and crisis intervention services during emergency responses
- Collaborate with protection and case management teams to ensure holistic client support
- Train 15 community volunteers in basic psychosocial support and mental health awareness
- Maintain accurate case documentation and contribute to program monitoring and evaluation

Psychosocial Counselor | HealthNet TPO

Herat, Afghanistan | March 2019 - December 2021

- Managed a caseload of 200+ clients annually, providing individual counseling for depression, anxiety, and trauma-related disorders
- Co-facilitated support groups for adolescent girls addressing stress, coping skills, and emotional regulation
- Implemented community-based MHPSS activities reaching 500+ beneficiaries through awareness sessions
- Provided specialized support to 40+ GBV survivors, coordinating with legal and medical services
- Participated in weekly clinical supervision and case conferences to ensure quality care
- Contributed to development of culturally adapted counseling materials and resources

Mental Health Counselor (Internship) | Afghanistan National Public Health Institute

Kabul, Afghanistan | September 2018 - February 2019

- Completed 600+ supervised clinical hours providing counseling services under licensed psychologist supervision
- Assisted in mental health screenings and psychosocial assessments for 100+ patients
- Participated in multidisciplinary team meetings and treatment planning sessions

EDUCATION

Master of Arts in Clinical Psychology

Kabul University, Kabul, Afghanistan | 2018

Bachelor of Science in Psychology

Kabul University, Kabul, Afghanistan | 2016

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

- ✓ MHPSS in Humanitarian Settings Certification- WHO/IASC, 2023
- ✓ Psychological First Aid (PFA) Training- Johns Hopkins University (online), 2022
- ✓ GBV Case Management and Psychosocial Support- UNFPA/UN Women, 2021
- ✓ Trauma-Informed Care Certification- Substance Abuse and Mental Health Services Administration (SAMHSA), 2021
- ✓ Child Protection and Mental Health- Terre des Hommes Foundation, 2020
- ✓ Cognitive Behavioral Therapy (CBT) Fundamentals- Beck Institute, 2020
- ✓ Mental Health Gap Action Programme (mhGAP) Training- WHO, 2019

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

- Member, Afghanistan Psychologists Association (APA)
- Member, International Association for Counselling (IAC)

LANGUAGES

Dari:Native

Pashto:Fluent (Speaking, Reading, Writing)

English:Professional Working Proficiency (Speaking, Reading, Writing)

REFERENCES

Dr. Fatima Ahmadi | MHPSS Program Manager

International Rescue Committee (IRC) | fatima.ahmadi@rescue.org

Mr. Mohammad Hassan | Clinical Supervisor

HealthNet TPO | m.hassan@healthnet.org

Dr. Zahra Noori | Professor of Psychology

Kabul University | z.noori@ku.edu.af